Nobel laureate Amartya Sen said, 'Only an *authoritarian government can calmly cause such misery to the people* – with millions of innocent people being deprived of their money and being subjected to *suffering, inconvenience and indignity* in trying to get their own money back.' And '*Demonetization goes against trust*. It undermines the trust in the entire economy.'[10]

Lawrence Summers commented: 'It is petty fortunes, not the hugest and most problematic ones, that are being targeted. *Without new measures to combat corruption, we doubt that this currency reform will have lasting benefits*.'[11]

Kaushik Basu called the policy 'Poorly designed, with scant attention paid to the laws of the market.' He further said, '*Demonetization was ostensibly implemented to combat corruption, terrorism financing and inflation – these justifications are flawed*.'[12]

Debunking the theory that this demonetization was based on his prescription of a cashless economy, Harvard economist and author of *The Curse of Cash*, Kenneth Rogoff, said unambiguously, '*My plan is explicitly tailored to advanced economies*. The idea in *The Curse of Cash* of eliminating large notes and not replacing them *is not aimed at developing countries, where the share of people without effective access to banking is just too large*.'[13]

However, there were others who praised the move. Columbia University's Professor Jagdish Bhagwati called it, '*A courageous and substantive economic reform*, whose potential benefits could include shrinking the shadow economy, hurting terrorists and counterfeiters, and expanding the tax base by digitizing many economic transactions.'[14]

Arvind Virmani, former chief economist and Indian representative to the International Monetary Fund (IMF), backed the move, stating, 'Demonetization is a *useful method of flushing out black money*, given that a large percentage of cash holding is in these two denominations.'[15]